

Expense Reimbursement Policy

Policy ID	FIN-EXP-101	Owner	Finance Operations
Effective	January 1, 2026	Next review	January 1, 2027
Status	Current	Classification	Internal
Audience	Employees and approving managers	Company	Northstar Technologies (fictional)

Document notice: This policy is fictional and was created for retrieval-augmented generation testing. It is not legal, tax, medical, or employment advice.

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy governs business expenses, documentation, approval, submission timing, missing receipts, corporate cards, and reimbursement. Travel-specific limits are described in the Business Travel Policy.

This policy applies across company offices and approved remote locations unless a local addendum or controlling law provides a different rule. Employees should use the current policy version and ask the listed owner when facts do not fit the standard case.

2. Summary of Key Rules

Expense	Receipt rule	Approval
Under \$25	Receipt preferred	Manager
\$25-\$499	Itemized receipt required	Manager
\$500 or more	Itemized receipt and business justification	Manager and cost-center owner
Alcohol	Only approved client events	Vice president

3. Allowable Business Expenses

An expense must be reasonable, necessary, actually incurred, and connected to company business. Personal upgrades, commuting, fines, entertainment without a business purpose, and expenses reimbursed by another party are not allowable. Employees should choose economical options while considering safety, accessibility, and business continuity.

4. Submission and Documentation

Expense reports should be submitted within 30 calendar days after the expense date or trip end. Reports require the amount, date, vendor, business purpose, attendees when relevant, cost center, and itemized receipt. A credit-card slip showing only the total is not an itemized receipt. Finance may request additional support before payment.

5. Missing Receipts and Exceptions

When an itemized receipt cannot reasonably be obtained, the employee must submit a missing-receipt declaration and evidence of payment. Repeated missing receipts may lead to delayed reimbursement or corporate-card review. Exceptions require written approval from the cost-center owner and Finance; manager approval alone does not override a prohibited category.

6. Payment and Corporate Cards

Approved reimbursements are paid in a separate payment run and may not appear with salary. Corporate cards must be used only by the assigned employee for authorized expenses. Personal charges must be repaid promptly and disclosed on the report. Lost cards and suspected fraudulent transactions must be reported to the card issuer and Finance immediately.

7. Exceptions, Records, and Questions

Exceptions must be lawful, documented, limited in duration, and approved by the policy owner plus any other owner named in the relevant section. Approval for one case does not change the policy for other employees. Records are retained according to the company retention schedule and any legal hold.

Related documents: Business Travel Policy; Payroll Calendar and Cutoffs Policy; Workplace Conduct and Reporting Policy.

Version history

Version	Effective date	Change
1.0	January 1, 2026	Initial fictional policy issued for RAG evaluation.